the Government had agreed to a General Election in Burma on the issue of separation from India. This election, held in November 1932, gave a majority to the anti-separationists, but taking advantage of the fact that the Burma Legislative Council did not vote for unconditional federation with India, the Government proceeded with their pet scheme of separation from India. The second Burma Round Table Conference was therefore called in 1933, and the anti-separationists, though in a majority in Burma, were given less seats than the separationists. It is now certain that Burma will be separated from India[1] and will be given a bi-cameral legislature for dealing with both 'provincial' and 'central' subjects.

In December, important conferences were held as usual. The Liberal Federation met at Madras with Mr. J. N. Basu in the chair and condemned the White Paper. The All-India Women Conference had a successful session in Calcutta and great enthusiasm was evinced by women representatives from all parts of India in the matter of educational and social reform as well as in the matter of representation in International Committees in Geneva. The Trade Union Congress met at Cawnpore and among the resolutions passed was one dealing with the grievances of the textile workers in Bombay Presidency and the necessity of a general strike of textile workers for enforcing their demands. Following this decision, in the early part of 1934, a strike of textile workers was declared in Bombay. There was enthusiastic response to the strike-call in Bombay and there were sympathetic strikes in other parts of the country as well. To break the strike, the bogey of Communism was raised once again and on that pretext, a large number of influential labour leaders in Bombay were thrown into prison. Following Bombay, other provinces like Punjab also saw the spectre of Communism stalking over the land and the Kirti (Workers), Kishan (Peasant) Party of Punjab was therefore declared illegal as being a Communist body. While strengthening the grip over the radical wing of the Workers' movement, the Government also took further measures in Bengal to crush the terrorist campaign of the revolutionaries. While, the year before, mere attempt to murder had been made punishable with death, in 1934, possession of arms, explosives, etc. was similarly

[1] The Report of the Joint Parliamentary Committee published on November 22nd, 1934, has provided for the separation of Burma from India.